

Chapter 4 Test Answers

TR 4.10A

Matching [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Match each item to the correct answer.

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| <u>D</u> 1. “Do your best to present yourself to God . . .” | A. 1 Thessalonians 2:13 |
| <u>C</u> 2. “But be doers of the word, and not hearers only . . .” | B. 2 Timothy 3:16–17 |
| <u>B</u> 3. “All Scripture is . . . profitable . . .” | C. James 1:22 |
| <u>A</u> 4. “. . . the word of God which is at work in you believers.” | D. 2 Timothy 2:15 |
| <u>C</u> 5. Historical context | A. The genre, structure, and grammar of a text |
| <u>B</u> 6. Eternal relevance | B. The quality of speaking to all in every age and in every culture |
| <u>D</u> 7. Historical particularity | C. The time, place, culture, and audience of a text |
| <u>A</u> 8. Literary context | D. The quality of having been spoken in a specific language to a specific culture at a specific time |

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

9. What factors make the Bible a difficult book to understand?
- a. It was written in a cultural context that is foreign to us.
 - b. It is not relevant to our lives today.
 - c. It was written to people who lived thousands of years ago.
 - d. It is the most important book of all time.
 - e. It was written in ancient languages.
10. Most Christians in history did not own their own Bibles. Why?
- a. Bibles were too expensive.
 - b. Many Christians did not know how to read.
 - c. They did not value the Word of God.
 - d. They did not have a systematic plan for Bible reading.
11. Hermeneutics is . . .
- a. the lack of intellectual discipline that leads people to err in reading Scripture.
 - b. the process of devising the best methods for understanding and interpreting a text.
 - c. the difference between the origin of a text and its destination.
 - d. the failure of modern science and technology to produce a utopian existence.



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12. What is context?
- a. the reference that gives the location of a passage in the Bible
 - b. the historical background and literary setting of a text that helps clarify its meaning
 - c. a verse that proves someone wrong
 - d. the meaning of words or the subject matter of a text
13. What is exegesis?
- a. the exposition or explanation of a text based on careful study and analysis
 - b. the ordering of a text of Scripture into chapters, verses, lines, and words
 - c. reading our own ideas, biases, or cultural assumptions into a text
 - d. the application of contemporary standards in interpreting a biblical passage
14. How do good Bible commentaries help readers?
- a. They provide discussions of difficult Bible texts, what they might mean, and the supporting arguments for each meaning.
 - b. They provide information about the historical context of Scripture and the ancient cultures described in it.
 - c. They tell what Bible passages say, answering many content questions.
 - d. They discuss the Hebrew, Greek, or Aramaic words used in a Bible passage.

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word(s) to make it true.

- T 15. A mistake people often make is assuming that the Bible does not need to be interpreted.
- F 16. In interacting with the Bible, we should individualize it, assuming that it applies to us in a unique way regardless of its original context. should not
- F 17. The right way to read the Bible is to interpret it based on contemporary standards. wrong
- F 18. Bible helps are necessary in understanding the historical and literary exegesis of Scripture. context
- T 19. Looking for relationships helps us gain a fuller understanding of what God is communicating to us through Scripture. _____

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- ___F___ 20. Few passages in the Bible are descriptive, telling us about God's plan of redemption through narratives about the people of God and teaching us through inference and example. ___Most___
- ___T___ 21. The Bible contains prescriptive passages that give us specific instructions and commands regarding how we should live. _____
- ___T___ 22. We must approach Scripture with humility, making ourselves fit it, rather than trying to make it fit us. _____

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points. Question 28 is worth 4 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

23. We must value _____ all _____, of Scripture, not just the sections that serve our agendas.
24. Though the Bible is historically particular because it was communicated in specific languages, times, and cultures, it is eternally _____ relevant _____, in that it speaks to all people.
25. The phrase *Tolle lege* convinced Augustine to pick up and _____ read _____ the Bible.
26. A _____ free _____ translation _____ or paraphrase, prioritizes communicating ideas from one language to another rather than using the exact words of the original.
27. A _____ formal _____ equivalence _____ translation seeks to preserve the words and grammar of the original language as much as possible.
28. A _____ functional _____ or _____ dynamic _____ equivalence translation attempts to keep the words and grammar of the original language, but adjusts idioms and grammar in the translation so that the ideas of the original will be understood.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

29. Give three examples of benefits that the Bible brings to those who read it.
Answers will vary but should include at least three of the following: reading the Bible brings blessings such as wisdom, hope, protection against doing evil; freedom from shame and/or bondage; insight for bearing spiritual fruit; direction in life; and the ability to grasp truth and defeat error.

30. Explain why the idea that the Bible does not need to be interpreted is wrong.
The idea that the Bible does not need to be interpreted is wrong because no one can keep from interpreting it; every reader brings to the text his or her experiences, culture, and prior understandings of words and ideas.
31. Can we say that a Bible verse applies uniquely to us? Why or why not?
We cannot say that a verse applies uniquely to us because it was not written to us but to a specific audience in particular circumstance.
32. What are three specific actions we take to apply what we learn in Scripture?
Three specific actions we take to apply what we learn in Scripture are journaling, sharing what we learn, and putting it into practice.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

33. What is postmodernism? How does it affect the way one reads texts, especially the Bible? In what ways is postmodernism compatible or incompatible with biblical Christianity?
Postmodernism is a worldview that teaches that there is no defining source for truth and reality. A person with a postmodernist worldview believes that there are no universal truths that apply to all people and that all you can know is your own “truth,” determined by your experience. This means that in reading, postmodernists believe the author’s intentions do not matter as much as the reader’s experience, and they apply this conviction to the Bible too. Postmodernism is incompatible with biblical Christianity because Christians believe there are universal truths that apply to all people and that God communicated these in Scripture.
34. Self-centeredness is a sin common to many of the hermeneutical mistakes listed in this chapter. What are some ways that self-centeredness affects our ability to read the Bible well?
Self-centeredness can affect our ability to read the Bible well because it can make us think that Scripture applies uniquely to us, so that we ignore its context. It can also lead us to ignore or misinterpret passages that do not align with our experience or convictions, even to the point where we do not concern ourselves with what God wants but invent our own meanings and uses for the Bible. Examples of self-centered reading of the Bible include taking verses out context to support evils such as slavery or teaching that Bible is all about how to gain health and wealth and live a prosperous life.

35. What are the kinds of context to keep in mind when reading the Bible? How does the context inform our understanding of individual passages and the larger story of the Bible?
Context is the historical background and literary setting of a text that helps clarify its meaning. It includes historical context, meaning the time, place, culture, and audience of a text, and the literary context, meaning the genre, structure, and grammar of a text. Knowing the historical and literary contexts of passage helps us to understand whether it should be taken literally or not, and what it might have meant to the people for whom it was written.
36. Summarize this chapter's recommendations on dealing with doubts.
Many people have experienced doubt, including John the Baptist, Peter, Thomas, and Martin Luther. Doubt can cause worry and fear, but it is part of spiritual growth. Our doubts can encourage us to ask good questions and persevere until we get good answers. When we have doubts, we should look for help from commentaries and other resources. We can ask for help from others at church. We can also trust that God is working on us.